Peak electricity demand up 43%

An IMF staff paper, checked against NSO, Eurostat and Luqa weather data

THE CLAIM

“Peak electricity demand has increased rapidly in recent years, rising from 465 MW in 2018 to 663 MW in 2023.”

IMF staff, Taking Stock of Infrastructure in Malta, SIP/2025/007, Feb 2025

Para. 5: this ‘significantly outpaced’ population and tourists (+13%).

The paper adds that the rise ‘may be related’ to hotter summers (27.3 °C to 29.6 °C).

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

Figures exact; the end years flatter the trend.

SUPPORTED | **LARGELY SUPPORTED** | NOT SUBSTANTIATED | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

663 MW

Peak, July 2023

NSO maximum demand; 465 MW in August 2018. The rise is 42.6%.

+13.4%

People present

Residents plus August tourists, 2018–2023, by the IMF’s own method (Eurostat).

+13.4%

Energy used

Final electricity consumption grew with the population; the peak grew far faster.

+24%

On the trend line

Over five years, 2017–2025. Other end years give 28% to 37%.

26.9 → 29.4

Hottest month, °C

Luqa: 2018 was the coolest summer of 2017–2025, 2023 the hottest.

FAIR TO SAY

This tests the paper’s figures, not its view on capacity, its 2040 projection or the 2026 power cuts.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ IMF: the series and weather station used.
- ☐ NSO: Table 7 of the 2024 and 2025 releases.
- ☐ Enemalta / REWS: hourly system load 2017–2025.
- ☐ No right of reply needed.